

Olajumoke Michael

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FOUNDER REVIEW — NOT APPROVED FOR PUBLICATION

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Program strategist, systems builder and operational leader who turns complex priorities into workable programs and operating structures. I work across program and service architecture, implementation leadership, and measurement and learning—connecting the proposition behind an initiative to the people, processes and evidence required to deliver it and improve what happens next. My experience spans entrepreneurship support, higher education, nonprofit and international program settings.

AREAS OF CONTRIBUTION

Program & Service Architecture • Implementation Leadership • Measurement & Learning

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Ethnoir | Founder

2025–present · Winston-Salem, North Carolina

- Translated the Venture Readiness Lab proposition into a six-week founder journey connecting assessment, learning, implementation and evidence collection; designed the program architecture, curriculum, operating approach and participant workflow.
- Led cohort delivery, participant support and adaptation; personally reviewed five participant-created structural deliverables and used the evidence—and its limitations—to determine what to retain, modify, test or defer.

Bpeace | U.S. Program Manager (Contract)

2025–2026 · Remote; program work across North Carolina and Georgia

- Led implementation of Breaking the \$1M Barrier for 21 growth-stage founders, building and managing the recruitment and selection process, founder journey, learning and coaching structures, engagement workflows, showcases and reporting mechanisms.
- Coordinated workshops, peer learning, one-to-one coaching, volunteer experts, partners and two Founder Showcases while adapting delivery to emerging participant and program needs.
- Synthesized participant and implementation evidence for funder reporting and recommendations about future program design.

Winston-Salem Women's Business Center | Program Director

2023–2025 · Winston-Salem, North Carolina

- Led entrepreneurship-support strategy and operations across nine North Carolina counties, overseeing programs, partnerships, grants, compliance, staff and contributor coordination, evaluation and reporting; the center served approximately 734 clients in 2024.
- Developed programs and strengthened participant-management, CRM, compliance and reporting systems; secured approximately \$740,000 through grants, sponsorships and partnerships.
- Led regional conferences, capital-access programming and cross-sector partnerships that connected entrepreneurs with expertise, institutions and resources.

Guilford College | Assistant Director, Advancement Operations

2021–2023 · Greensboro, North Carolina

- Strengthened advancement operations supporting more than \$3 million in annual giving by improving data integrity, constituent records, reporting and workflows across Advancement, IT and database functions.
- Managed data imports and migration-related work and resolved process issues affecting gift administration, stewardship and institutional reporting.

SuccorAfrica Communications Ltd | Project Consultant

2019–2021 · Remote

- Coordinated multi-sector initiatives across Africa, developing implementation plans, monitoring and evaluation frameworks, and operating protocols aligned with donor requirements.
- Conducted post-project reviews and developed scale-up recommendations for subsequent implementation: improved internal processes and team onboarding to strengthen execution and stakeholder communication.

British High Commission | Grants & Program Manager

2014–2019 · Abuja, Nigeria

- Managed the full lifecycle of a £2.3 million grants and programs portfolio spanning justice, economic development and security-related initiatives, with responsibility for grant administration, partner coordination, monitoring, compliance, reporting and analysis.
- Improved resource-allocation and compliance processes associated with approximately \$90,000 in cost savings; produced analysis and briefs to support program and funding decisions across government, civil-society and international stakeholders.

SELECTED WORK

Designing a Founder Support Pilot—and Learning from Its Limits

Venture Readiness Lab · Ethnoir · 2026

Designed and led a six-week founder-support pilot from proposition through program architecture, operating systems, delivery and evidence review. All six active founders reached the final session; five participant-created structural business deliverables existed and were personally reviewed and confirmed. The resulting evidence informed decisions about what to retain, modify, test or defer in subsequent design.

[View Case Study →](#)

EDUCATION

MSc Environmental Management, University of South Wales

BSc Microbiology, Olabisi Onabanjo University